

## 7.1 Anti-Virus Programs

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All of you reading this know (hopefully!) the importance of having an anti-virus installed. There was a time when it wasn't essential, but that time has long gone—traffic on the Internet contains so much malicious junk these days that often, when you connect a virgin computer to the Net, you're attacked before you can download virus definitions!

Here, we talk about the free anti-virus programs available for download. We have no idea why people pay for anti-virus software when you have these programs available!

### 7.1.1 avast! Home Edition

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#### Our Experience

avast! is one of the most widely-used free anti-virus software out there. Lots of us here at *Digit* use it at home, too.

An anti-virus cannot be tested the way other software is tested—you'd need to throw viruses at it in order to test it, and since we don't have any viruses at hand, we can't do that! One other thing we could do is to install various anti-virus software, and see which one catches the most viruses. However, all our computers here at *Digit* are virus-free, so we can't do that either! The only thing we could do is, of course, install the anti-virus



You can customise the sensitivity of each of the 'providers' in avast!. Higher sensitivity means more system resources